

After completing this lesson, you will be able to:

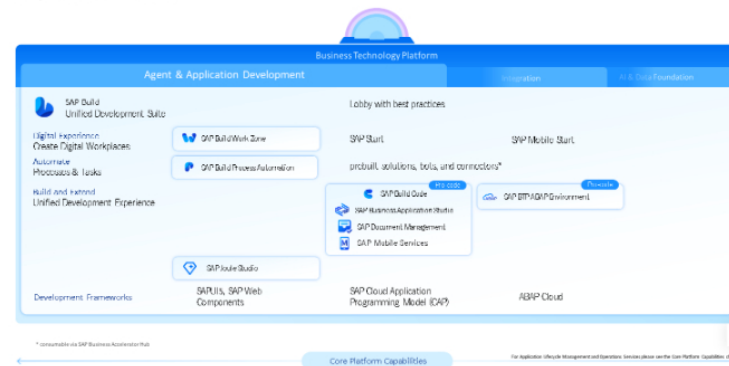
- Discover application development.
- Discover automation.
- Analyze the roles regarding application development and automation.

Your company utilizes various SAP software, majorly cloud-based, within your intelligent enterprise. You intend to adapt UI screens, broaden existing SAPUI5 apps with APIs, and run a personalized development app on SAP BTP. You also aim to streamline your employees' digital experience.

Further, your company encompasses numerous business processes, procedures, and tasks, with varying levels of automation. To augment the process automation and reduce manual tasks, you are considering SAP Build Process Automation. Developers and business process experts, transformed into citizen developers, can accomplish this automation.

SAP BTP Agent & Application Development Cloud Services

Build, Innovate and Automate



As the market shifts towards SaaS solutions, you're unable to modify the software as with older on-premise systems. SAP even advises maintaining the core software clean in on-premise systems, promoting extensions over modifications. This necessitates adopting new methods of custom development and software portfolio extensions in your enterprise.

The app development capabilities of SAP BTP provide a portfolio of solutions that simplify the development of application extensions or custom applications. While optimized for SAP applications to augment their value, the platform is also compatible with third-party application extensions.

SAP also offers a comprehensive toolkit for both front-end and back-end developers, including professional development tools and mechanics for AI development experiences with Joule. This diverse toolset empowers you to craft a unified user experience for your end-users.

You can read more about Application Development in the [SAP Help Portal](#) and on [SAP.com](#).

If you're aiming to automate business processes for increased agility or reduced manual effort, SAP BTP provides enterprise automation capabilities through SAP Build. SAP Build brings together workflows, robotic process automation, visual development, and AI-based agents in a unified environment.

A key component of this ecosystem is Joule, SAP's AI copilot. Beyond using standard capabilities, developers and business experts can use SAP Build to create custom Joule agents and extend business processes with Joule skills. This allows Joule to execute specific tasks and manage complex workflows across different systems, acting as an intelligent orchestrator for enterprise automation. In earlier industry discussions, this approach was often described as "hyperautomation" to highlight the combination of AI and automation. Today, SAP focuses on enterprise automation by combining process automation, AI capabilities, and autonomous agents to handle end-to-end business processes across applications and data.

Enterprise automation refers to the strategic use of technologies like RPA, AI, and business process management to streamline processes across an entire organization. This journey often begins often with SAP Signavio, which provides visibility into your IT landscape to identify inefficiencies and prioritize the most impactful automation opportunities. To ensure these processes flow seamlessly, SAP Integration Suite connects SAP and third-party applications across complex multi-cloud environments. By leveraging SAP Build, you can then rapidly optimize these processes by building AI-driven automations and custom Joule agents that act as digital coworkers. These agents can even initiate tasks asynchronously through event-driven architectures to handle complex business logic. This holistic approach replaces manual tasks with integrated workflows in areas like order processing or supply chain operations. Ultimately, these integrated workflows reduce manual intervention and allow organizations to scale their operations while enabling employees to focus on more complex, value-adding activities. [Learn more in this learning journey: Discovering Enterprise Automation with SAP](#) [\[2\]](#)

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With the growth of digitalization, the market for technological requirements has become volatile. Business needs are constantly changing, causing many companies to adapt quickly. To bridge the resourcing gap for technical talent, SAP provides solutions that empower employees across different skill levels to contribute to the development lifecycle.

The following summarizes the differences between the roles:

Professional Developers

Professional developers focus on creating complex applications and services. They are responsible for the entire development lifecycle, including design, coding, testing, and versioning. They have a deep understanding of software architecture, permissions, and roles. Professional developers often work alongside other roles to provide expertise that extends beyond standard frameworks, ensuring that complex business logic is implemented securely and efficiently.

Administrators

IT Administrators ensure the governance, operations, and technical monitoring of the entire landscape. They manage the lifecycle of business applications and processes by controlling upgrades and technical security. Their role is to coordinate the path to production, ensuring that all assets created by developers meet the required standards before they reach the productive environment. They also manage essential platform components such as service instances, destinations, environments and authorizations within SAP BTP and SAP Build.

Citizen Developers

Citizen developers are business experts who identify and improve processes within their specific departments. They design and deploy focused applications and automated workflows that address immediate business needs. By leveraging AI-assisted development and natural language capabilities, they can create functional solutions without requiring extensive technical backgrounds. Citizen developers often work in tandem with professional developers. While citizen developers focus on the business logic and user experience of departmental tools, professional developers provide the robust architecture and complex integrations required for enterprise-scale solutions. This collaborative approach ensures that applications are both agile and technically sound.

Enriching Development through Fusion Teams

Fusion Teams blend various roles, bringing together Professional Developers, Citizen Developers, and Business Experts to form a collaborative and innovative ecosystem. This cross-functional collaboration strengthens communication, ensures holistic solutions, and leverages reusable components like UX designs and decision logics across projects for greater efficiency. Moreover, these teams enable robust lifecycle management—covering planning, development, implementation, and continuous monitoring of solutions—to ensure high quality and stability. By involving Business Users and Citizen Developers, organizations can expand their talent pool, enhancing access to fresh ideas and innovative approaches.

Key Takeaways Of This Lesson

SAP Business Technology Platform (SAP BTP) offers a comprehensive ecosystem for application and agent development, centered on the principle of maintaining a clean core while extending business value. To navigate this landscape effectively, it is essential to distinguish between three key roles: the professional developer, who uses advanced tools and coding to build complex solutions; the citizen developer, a business expert who leverages AI-assisted visual development tools to automate processes without extensive programming knowledge; and the IT administrator, who ensures governance, security, and lifecycle management across the platform. By combining these roles into fusion teams and utilizing capabilities like SAP Build and Joule, organizations can bridge the technical talent gap, accelerate enterprise automation, and respond with agility to volatile market requirements.

Was this lesson helpful? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Next lesson →